Joker of Academics

Research on Temporal Hegemony and Discourse Blocking Based on the Evolutionary Model: A Guide to Dinosaur Workplace Survival in the Late Cretaceous

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Abstract: This paper examines how tenure is transformed from a descriptive variable into a source of discursive authority in organizations. Building on field theory, epistemic injustice, and voice/silence research, we formalize a Chronological Hegemony (CH) model with four linked components: tenure (τ), discursive weight (Ω), blocking intensity (Ψ), and field-level hegemony (H). The model shows how seniority-based legitimacy claims can suppress evidence-sensitive evaluation at the interaction level, reduce junior participation through empathy refusal and response delay, and accumulate into macro-level rigidity. Three consequences follow: (1) authority can decouple from evidential quality under pure seniority rules; (2) semantic ecosystems can drift toward conformity and away from innovation; and (3) organizations may preserve internal order while losing external sensing capacity, increasing adaptation risk after environmental shifts. The contribution is not to deny the value of experience, but to separate experiential insight from tenure absolutism and to provide testable parameters for intervention. Practical implications include designing evidence-weighted review channels, reducing cross-rank blocking, and monitoring early indicators of silencing and hidden alienation.

Keywords: Chronological Hegemony; Discursive Blocking; Evolutionary Model; Organizational Ecology

1. Introduction

In contemporary organizations, conflicts over knowledge rarely begin as explicit disputes about evidence. They often appear as judgments about who has "earned" the right to interpret reality. A familiar sentence captures this logic with striking efficiency: "X to Y: You have only been here for a few years?" The line circulates as a joke in online culture, yet its humor depends on a serious social fact. Duration in a workplace is routinely treated as more than elapsed time; it is converted into a credential that authorizes some actors to define what counts as competence, prudence, and even objectivity. This paper examines that conversion process and asks how temporal seniority is transformed into an apparently natural claim to truth [23, 20].

The core problem is not that experience matters; experience does matter. The problem is that duration is frequently alienated into epistemic ownership, meaning the socially enforced right to decide whose interpretation is intelligible and whose voice is premature. Once this conversion is stabilized, disagreement from newer members is recoded as immaturity rather than as potentially valid critique. In this way, chronology operates as a hidden gatekeeper within ordinary interaction, shaping not only promotion or status but the cognitive boundaries of the field itself [12, 28, 26, 27].

Seen from this perspective, duration becomes a political resource rather than a neutral timeline. Years-in-field can be mobilized as symbolic proof, detached from concrete evidence and reattached to positional authority. A senior actor may make weaker arguments yet receive stronger uptake because the audience reads longevity as a proxy for reliability. A junior actor may provide better data yet face skepticism because short tenure is interpreted as a deficit of legitimacy. The result is a patterned asymmetry in who is heard, who is doubted, and who bears the burden of justification [25, 12, 23, 30].

Bourdieu's theory of field and capital is indispensable for understanding this asymmetry. In field struggle, actors compete over the power to impose legitimate classifications, and symbolic capital allows certain positions to pass particular interests off as universal standards [3, 4, 20]. Organizational duration can be read as one convertible form of such capital: time spent in the field is translated into authority over naming, ranking, and boundary-policing. Through this translation, incumbents do not merely defend resources; they defend interpretive jurisdiction. What appears as institutional memory may therefore also function as a mechanism for reproducing orthodoxy and muting heterodox entrants.

Foucault's analytics of discipline deepens this account by showing how authority is reproduced through dispersed micro-practices rather than only formal hierarchy [10]. Temporal gatekeeping works through mundane acts: interruption styles, evaluative tone, mentoring scripts, onboarding rituals, and retrospective narratives about "how things are done here." These practices do not always rely on direct coercion. They organize visibility, normalize deference, and shape what can be said without social penalty [6, 22, 8, 11]. The meme sentence quoted above is analytically useful because it condenses this disciplinary operation into a compact utterance: it is at once a credential check, a rank reminder, and a warning about the cost of speaking outside one's assigned temporal station.

Research in professional sociology and organizational theory also clarifies why this mechanism persists. Abbott's work on jurisdiction highlights how expert groups defend problem domains by controlling legitimate methods and vocabularies [1]. Stinchcombe's account of organizational imprinting suggests that historical conditions become sedimented into durable routines [29]. Field-theoretic developments by Fligstein and McAdam show how incumbents stabilize strategic action fields through shared understandings that appear natural to insiders [9]. Cumulative-advantage dynamics further indicate that early positional gains can compound over time, making later evaluations look meritocratic even when opportunity structures are skewed [25]. Yet these traditions explain much about hierarchy, while leaving a specific temporal mechanism under-theorized.

The blind spot is subtle but consequential. Across many influential frameworks, time span tends to appear as contextual background, a proxy variable, or a linear control in empirical models. What is less developed is a direct account of how elapsed time is converted into epistemic entitlement in interactional practice. Under what conditions does duration become proof? Which rhetorical forms activate temporal hierarchy most effectively? How do organizations train members to treat long tenure as credibility even when evidential quality is uncertain? Why do some contexts convert years into authority almost automatically, while others keep duration and truth claims partially decoupled? Without addressing these questions, analyses of power risk describing stable outcomes while overlooking a key operational pathway that produces them [27, 15, 19].

This paper treats tenure as an operator, not a background variable. The analysis isolates when time-in-organization is used as evidence and when it is used as a gatekeeping shortcut. The aim is narrow: separate experience-based contribution from chronology-based veto, and make that distinction testable in interaction data [8, 11, 14].

The CH framework tracks three linked processes: conversion of tenure into credibility weight, blockage in cross-rank communication, and cumulative rigidity at field level. A recurrent sentence pattern is: "You have only been here for X years; what X means, I define." In this pattern, X is an insinuative signifier; chronology is used to pre-filter who can speak as a knower [16, 27].

The paramecium–dinosaur dialogue is used as a minimal model of rank talk. One clause states tenure; the next clause claims interpretive monopoly. That sequence matters because it shifts evaluation from claim quality to speaker identity. This paper studies that shift as a mechanism, not as a personality trait.

Figure 1: Conceptual scene of temporal gatekeeping and discursive authority conflict. The interaction stages a rank-asymmetry in which one actor frames tenure as epistemic authority before evidence comparison begins.

2. The CH Model

2.1 Variables and Chrono-Operator

Let the current interaction time be t, and let each actor i enter the field at time $t_{0,i}$. The tenure variable

is

$$\tau_i(t) = t - t_{0,i}, \quad \tau_i \geq 0. \tag{1}$$

We define $t_{0,i}$ as the power origin in the temporal game, and construct the Chrono-Operator as the discursive weight map

$$\Omega_i(\tau_i) = \kappa \cdot \ln(1 + \tau_i) + \zeta, \tag{2}$$

where $\kappa > 0$ is the seniority gain coefficient and $\zeta \in \mathbb{R}$ is the baseline discursive bias.

The operator has two immediately verifiable properties:

$$\frac{\partial \Omega_i}{\partial \tau_i} = \frac{\kappa}{1 + \tau_i} > 0, \tag{3}$$

$$\frac{\partial^2 \Omega_i}{\partial \tau_i^2} = -\frac{\kappa}{(1 + \tau_i)^2} < 0. \tag{4}$$

Hence discursive weight is strictly increasing in tenure but with diminishing marginal gain. This matters for identification: the mechanism is monotone ("more senior, more weight") yet non-linear ("late seniority adds less than early seniority").

For comparison, a linear seniority map $\Omega_i^{\text{lin}}(\tau_i) = a\tau_i + \zeta$ with $a > 0$ preserves strict monotonicity but removes concavity. The conclusions in §2.2 only require strict monotonicity, not a specific functional form.

2.2 The Paramecium Limit

To formalize reductio, consider pairwise definition contests. Let

$$D_{i \succ j} = \mathbf{1}[\Omega_i > \Omega_j] \tag{5}$$

be the indicator that i obtains final definitional priority over j.

Axiom S (pure seniority rule). If $\Omega_i > \Omega_j$, then $D_{i \succ j} = 1$.

If $\Omega(\tau)$ is strictly increasing (logarithmic or linear), Axiom S is equivalent to

$$\tau_i > \tau_j \implies D_{i \succ j} = 1. \tag{6}$$

Now select two biological agents: Paramecium (p) and dinosaur (d), with evolutionary tenure

$$\tau_p > \tau_d, \tag{7}$$

and cognitive-complexity ordering

$$c_p < c_d. \tag{8}$$

By strict monotonicity, $\Omega(\tau_p) > \Omega(\tau_d)$, thus $D_{p \succ d} = 1$. Therefore a lower-complexity but older life form has absolute definitional power over a higher-complexity but younger one. This is the Paramecium Limit.

The reductio is immediate. Suppose one also adopts a competence principle:

$$c_i > c_j \implies D_{i \succ j} = 1. \tag{9}$$

Then $c_d > c_p$ implies $D_{d \succ p} = 1$, contradicting $D_{p \succ d} = 1$. Hence pure seniority absolutism is logically incompatible with competence-based epistemic ordering.

We can further state the "entropy-defense" implication using a binary truth model. Let $q_i \in (1/2, 1)$ be actor i's probability of producing a correct claim, and define epistemic entropy

$$h(q) = -q \ln q - (1 - q) \ln(1 - q). \tag{10}$$

On $[1/2, 1)$, $h'(q) = \ln\left(\frac{1-q}{q}\right) < 0$, so higher truth probability means lower entropy. Under pure seniority selection in the paramecium–dinosaur pair, collective correctness is q_p; under evidence-competence selection, it is q_d with $q_d > q_p$. Therefore

$$h(q_p) > h(q_d). \tag{11}$$

So seniority absolutism systematically preserves higher epistemic entropy (more uncertainty/noise) by defending incumbency against better signals. In this formal sense it is an entropy-increasing defense mechanism.

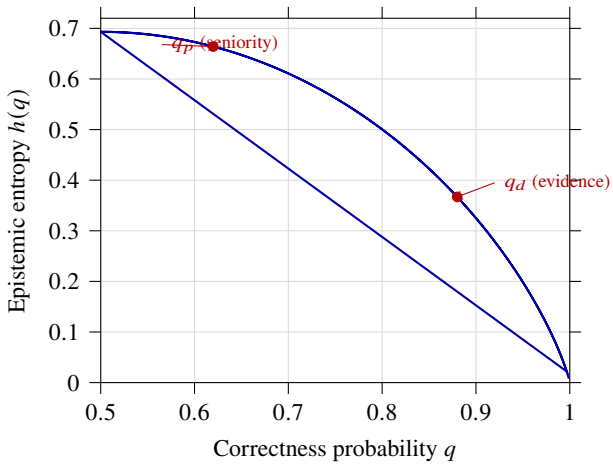

Figure 2: Entropy comparison for the Paramecium Limit. Seniority selection keeps correctness at q_p (higher entropy), while evidence-based selection moves it to q_d (lower entropy). The curve indicates that increased correctness reduces uncertainty, highlighting the q_p–q_d contrast.

Finally, if repeated contests frequently exhibit an

"older-but-simpler" structure, the authority-selected complexity sequence is biased downward because the rule picks age over capability each round. The logical endpoint is not adaptation to higher complexity, but lock-in toward lower-complexity admissible authorities [21, 24].

2.3 Discursive Blocking Coefficient Ψ

Let the seniority gap be

$$\Delta\tau = \tau_{\text{senior}} - \tau_{\text{junior}} \geq 0. \tag{12}$$

Define the discursive blocking coefficient as a logistic response:

$$\Psi(\Delta\tau) = \frac{1}{1 + \exp[-a(\Delta\tau - \theta)]}, \quad a > 0. \tag{13}$$

Here θ is the institutional blocking threshold and a is slope sensitivity. Communication efficiency is then

$$E(\Delta\tau) = E_0\big(1 - \Psi(\Delta\tau)\big) = \frac{E_0}{1 + \exp\big[a(\Delta\tau - \theta)\big]} \tag{14}$$

This yields three testable claims:

$$E(\Delta\tau) \leq \varepsilon E_0 \iff \Delta\tau \geq \theta + \frac{1}{a}\ln\left(\frac{1-\varepsilon}{\varepsilon}\right), \quad 0 < \varepsilon < \frac{1}{2}. \tag{15}$$

The last inequality defines the discursive limit condition: once the seniority gap crosses this critical value, effective communication is arbitrarily close to zero.

2.4 Logical Linkage to Subsequent Sections

To guarantee causal traceability, all constructs in Sections 3 and 4 are explicitly mapped to the primitives of Section 2. For a senior–junior pair (s, j), define

$$\Delta\tau_{sj} = \tau_s - \tau_j \geq 0, \tag{16}$$

$$\Delta\Omega_{sj} = \Omega_s - \Omega_j = \kappa \ln\left(\frac{1+\tau_s}{1+\tau_j}\right) > 0, \tag{17}$$

$$\Psi_{sj} = \Psi(\Delta\tau_{sj}) \in (0, 1). \tag{18}$$

At organizational level, let $\mathcal{P}$ be the set of observed senior–junior interaction pairs and define temporal-hegemony intensity

$$H = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{P}|} \sum_{(s,j)\in\mathcal{P}} \Psi_{sj} \in (0, 1). \tag{19}$$

Hence every downstream equation can be written as a function of (τ, Ω, Ψ), with H as an aggregate of pairwise blocking.

3. Micro-Semiotic Analysis of Temporal Bullying

3.1 Spatial and Physiological Symbolization of Power

Consider a dyad with a senior actor s and a junior actor j. Let

$$x = (x_1, x_2, x_3)^\top, \quad x_m \in [0, 1], \tag{20}$$

Drawing on localized manifestations of physical boundary violation in hierarchical cultures, we model three channels of embodied dominance. Specifically, x_1 denotes territorial posture intensity (e.g., expansive leg-crossing), x_2 denotes smoke-intrusion intensity, and x_3 denotes coercive drinking-test intensity.

Define physiological-pressure load on actor $a \in \{s, j\}$ as

$$P_a(x) = \sum_{m=1}^{3} \gamma_{a,m} x_m, \quad \gamma_{a,m} > 0. \tag{21}$$

The asymmetric pressure field is captured by

$$A(x) = P_j(x) - P_s(x) = \sum_{m=1}^{3} (\gamma_{j,m} - \gamma_{s,m}) x_m. \tag{22}$$

To anchor this asymmetry in Section 2, parameterize channel gaps as

$$\gamma_{j,m} - \gamma_{s,m} = \lambda_m \Delta\Omega_{sj} \Psi_{sj}, \quad \lambda_m > 0. \tag{23}$$

Then

$$A(x) = \Delta\Omega_{sj}\Psi_{sj} \sum_{m=1}^{3} \lambda_m x_m. \tag{24}$$

Since $\Delta\Omega_{sj} > 0$ and $\Psi_{sj} > 0$, any nonzero x implies $A(x) > 0$: the same behavior creates strictly larger load on the junior side.

To formalize the "power-sedation effect," define expressive gain

$$g_a(x) = \exp(-P_a(x)), \quad 0 < g_a \leq 1, \tag{25}$$

and relative junior expression capacity

$$R(x) = \frac{g_j}{g_s} = \exp(-A(x)). \tag{26}$$

Under $A > 0$, we get $0 < R < 1$. Moreover, for every channel m,

$$\frac{\partial R}{\partial x_m} = -\lambda_m \Delta\Omega_{sj} \Psi_{sj} \exp(-A(x)) < 0. \tag{27}$$

Hence increasing posture dominance, smoke intrusion, or coercive-ritual intensity monotonically suppresses junior-side expressive capacity relative to the senior side.

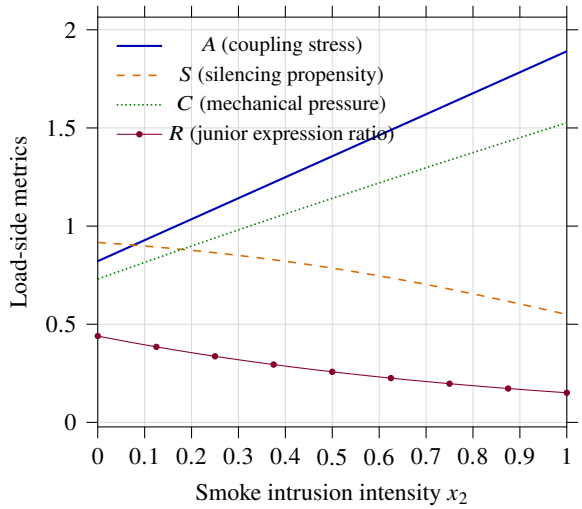

Figure 3: Joint dynamics of mechanical pressure and silencing propensity under varying smoke-intrusion intensities. As intrusion intensity increases, load-side indicators rise while expression-side indicators decline, indicating coupled deterioration in junior-side communicative viability.

3.2 Reconstruction of Qualification Rhetoric

The sentence pattern "I witnessed historical event H while you were still in a null state" can be modeled as a legitimacy-gating operator. Let τ_H be the minimum tenure required to claim witnessing authority over event H, and define

$$e_i(H) = \mathbf{1}[\tau_i \geq \tau_H] \in \{0, 1\}. \tag{28}$$

Let $q_i \in [0, 1]$ be evidential quality of actor i's claim. Before rhetoric, truth competition score is

$$S_i^{\text{truth}} = \Omega_i q_i. \tag{29}$$

After qualification rhetoric targets actor j, evaluation is rewritten as

$$S_i^{\text{qual}} = \Omega_i e_i(H) q_i. \tag{30}$$

Therefore, if $\tau_j < \tau_H$, then $e_j(H) = 0$ and

$$S_j^{\text{qual}} = 0 \quad \text{for all } q_j \in [0, 1], \tag{31}$$

which implies local insensitivity of outcome to junior evidence:

$$\frac{\partial S_j^{\text{qual}}}{\partial q_j} = 0 \quad (\tau_j < \tau_H). \tag{32}$$

By contrast, in the truth-first regime,

$$\frac{\partial S_j^{\text{truth}}}{\partial q_j} = \Omega_j > 0. \tag{33}$$

This proves the transformation mechanism: argument quality ceases to be the operative variable; existential-legitimacy gating becomes primary. In short, a truth discussion is rewritten as ontological deprivation [12, 20].

3.3 Empathy Refusal and Response Delay

Let interaction round be $t = 0, 1, 2, \ldots$. Define senior empathy level $m_t \in [0, 1]$ (higher means more empathy) and response delay $L_t \geq 0$. Junior voice potential evolves as

$$V_{t+1} = V_t - \alpha(1 - m_t) - \beta \ln(1 + L_t), \quad \alpha, \beta > 0. \tag{34}$$

Participation probability is

$$p_t = \sigma(V_t) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-V_t}}. \tag{35}$$

Applying chain rule yields

$$\frac{\partial p_{t+1}}{\partial m_t} = \alpha\, \sigma(V_{t+1})\,(1 - \sigma(V_{t+1})) > 0, \tag{36}$$

$$\frac{\partial p_{t+1}}{\partial L_t} = -\frac{\beta}{1 + L_t}\, \sigma(V_{t+1})\,(1 - \sigma(V_{t+1})) < 0. \tag{37}$$

Thus empathy refusal ($m_t \downarrow$) and delayed reply ($L_t \uparrow$) jointly reduce junior participation [6, 22, 8, 11]. Under a stationary bullying strategy, tie behavior to Section 2 blocking intensity by

$$m = \bar{m} - \eta_m \Psi_{sj}, \quad L = \bar{L} + \eta_L \Psi_{sj}, \tag{38}$$

with $\bar{m} \in (0, 1]$, $\bar{L} \geq 0$, $\eta_m, \eta_L > 0$, and feasibility constraint $0 \leq \bar{m} - \eta_m \Psi_{sj} \leq 1$. Then define

$$\begin{aligned} \delta(\Psi_{sj}) = \alpha\left(1 - \bar{m} + \eta_m \Psi_{sj}\right) \\ + \beta \ln\left(1 + \bar{L} + \eta_L \Psi_{sj}\right) > 0. \end{aligned} \tag{39}$$

$$\frac{\partial \delta}{\partial \Psi_{sj}} = \alpha \eta_m + \frac{\beta \eta_L}{1 + \bar{L} + \eta_L \Psi_{sj}} > 0. \tag{40}$$

Then

$$V_n = V_0 - n\delta(\Psi_{sj}), \tag{41}$$

and voice potential crosses zero after

$$n^\star = \left\lceil \frac{V_0}{\delta(\Psi_{sj})} \right\rceil. \tag{42}$$

Because Ψ_{sj} is increasing in $\Delta\tau_{sj}$ (Section 2.3), larger seniority gaps shorten the silencing horizon. Emotional bullying is therefore a causal downstream effect of the CH mechanism, not an independent assumption [27, 15, 19].

4. Late Cretaceous Organizational Ecology

In this section, macro-level pressure variable H is exactly the aggregate index defined in Section 2.4. Thus every organizational result is traced back to pairwise seniority gaps through Ψ.

4.1 Rigidity and Extinction Risk

Let external environment state at round t be $e_t \in \mathbb{R}$. Each actor i reports

$$y_{i,t} = e_t + b_{i,t} + \varepsilon_{i,t}, \tag{43}$$

where $b_{i,t}$ is regime bias and $\varepsilon_{i,t}$ is zero-mean noise with variance σ_i^2. The organization aggregates signals by tenure-hegemony weights

$$\alpha_i(H) = \frac{\exp(H\Omega_i)}{\sum_k \exp(H\Omega_k)}, \quad H \geq 0, \tag{44}$$

and decision estimate

$$\hat{e}_t(H) = \sum_i \alpha_i(H) y_{i,t}. \tag{45}$$

Assuming independent noises, adaptation loss is

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{L}(H) &= \mathbb{E}\left[(\hat{e}_t(H) - e_t)^2\right] \\ &= \left(\sum_i \alpha_i(H) b_{i,t}\right)^2 + \sum_i \alpha_i(H)^2 \sigma_i^2. \end{aligned} \tag{46}$$

Let $m = \arg\max_k \tau_k$, equivalently $m = \arg\max_k \Omega_k$ by Section 2.1 monotonicity. Then

$$\lim_{H\to\infty} \alpha_i(H) = \mathbf{1}[i = m], \tag{47}$$

so

$$\lim_{H\to\infty} \mathcal{L}(H) = b_{m,t}^2 + \sigma_m^2. \tag{48}$$

Hence at peak temporal hegemony the organization collapses to a single-seniority sensor: signal weighting depends only on tenure, not on current environmental fit. If, after regime shift, there exists a younger actor n with

$$b_{n,t}^2 + \sigma_n^2 < b_{m,t}^2 + \sigma_m^2, \tag{49}$$

then high-H governance is strictly suboptimal for adaptation. This is the formal "dinosaur extinction" prediction: incumbency supremacy can maximize internal authority while minimizing external sensing quality [2, 24, 7, 17].

To map sensing loss into survival pressure, define ecological hazard

$$\Lambda_{\text{ext}}(H) = \Lambda_0 \exp\left(\rho[\mathcal{L}(H) - \bar{\mathcal{L}}]_+\right), \quad \rho > 0, \tag{50}$$

which is increasing in $\mathcal{L}(H)$ whenever $\mathcal{L}(H) > \bar{\mathcal{L}}$ [7, 17, 18].

4.2 Gresham's Law in Discourse

Let $p(t) \in [0, 1]$ be the share of innovative utterances (N) in the semantic field, so $1 - p(t)$ is the share of seniority cliches (C).

Define payoffs

$$\pi_N = v_N - c_N - \lambda H, \tag{51}$$

$$\pi_C = v_C - c_C + \lambda H, \quad \lambda > 0, \tag{52}$$

where H is temporal-hegemony intensity and λH captures institutional reward for conformity. Replicator dynamics gives

$$\dot{p} = p(1-p)(\pi_N - \pi_C) = p(1-p)(\Delta_0 - 2\lambda H), \tag{53}$$

with

$$\Delta_0 = (v_N - v_C) - (c_N - c_C). \tag{54}$$

For fixed H, the closed-form solution is

$$p(t) = \frac{1}{1 + \left(\frac{1-p_0}{p_0}\right) e^{-(\Delta_0 - 2\lambda H)t}}, \tag{55}$$

where $p_0 = p(0) \in (0, 1)$. Therefore, if

$$H > H_G := \frac{\Delta_0}{2\lambda}, \tag{56}$$

then $\Delta_0 - 2\lambda H < 0$, so $p(t) \to 0$ as $t \to \infty$. Innovative speech is asymptotically expelled, while cliche share tends to one. This is Gresham's law in the semantic field: rhetorically "bad" discourse drives out epistemically "good" discourse [27, 19].

4.3 Compliance and Alienation

Following dramaturgical logic [13, 28], let $d_t \in [0, 1]$ be demanded front-stage loyalty script, $a_t \in [0, 1]$ be private backstage attitude, and $y_t \in [0, 1]$ be displayed behavior.

The subordinate chooses y_t by minimizing

$$J_t(y_t) = w_f(H)(y_t - d_t)^2 + w_b(y_t - a_t)^2, \tag{57}$$

where $w_b > 0$ and $w_f(H) = w_0 + w_1 H$ with $w_0, w_1 > 0$.

First-order optimality gives

$$y_t^\star = \frac{w_f(H)d_t + w_b a_t}{w_f(H) + w_b}. \tag{58}$$

Define front-stage disguise gap

$$F_t = \left|y_t^\star - a_t\right| = \frac{w_f(H)}{w_f(H) + w_b}|d_t - a_t|. \tag{59}$$

If $d_t \neq a_t$, then

$$\frac{\partial F_t}{\partial H} = \frac{w_1 w_b}{(w_f(H) + w_b)^2}|d_t - a_t| > 0. \tag{60}$$

So stronger temporal hegemony increases mandatory front-stage masking.

Let backstage aversion stock evolve as

$$B_{t+1} = (1 - \mu)B_t + \nu F_t, \quad 0 < \mu < 1, \ \nu > 0. \tag{61}$$

Under constant (H, d_t, a_t), stationary aversion is

$$B^\star = \frac{\nu}{\mu}F_t, \tag{62}$$

hence $\partial B^\star/\partial H > 0$ when $d_t \neq a_t$. This captures the false/real split: visible compliance increases on stage, while hidden disgust accumulates backstage [26, 27].

5. Simulation Study: 100-Agent Organization

To verify whether the full equation system produces coherent organizational dynamics, we run a small simulation with 100 agents over 60 rounds.

5.1 Setup and Conditions

The simulation is initialized with $N = 100$ agents over $T = 60$ interaction rounds. Initial tenure is sampled from a uniform distribution, $\tau_i \sim U(0.2, 25)$ years, and discursive weight follows $\Omega_i = \kappa \ln(1 + \tau_i) + \zeta$ with $(\kappa, \zeta) = (1.1, 0.2)$. Pairwise blocking is governed by $\Psi(\Delta\tau) = [1 + \exp\{-a(\Delta\tau - \theta)\}]^{-1}$, parameterized by $(a, \theta) = (0.55, 6.0)$.

Voice potential evolves as $V_{i,t+1} = V_{i,t} - \delta_i$, where

$$\delta_i = \alpha(1 - \bar{m} + \eta_m \bar{\Psi}_i) + \beta \ln(1 + \bar{L} + \eta_L \bar{\Psi}_i), \tag{63}$$

with $(\alpha, \beta, \bar{m}, \bar{L}, \eta_m, \eta_L) = (0.08, 0.12, 0.68, 0.45, 0.32, 0.90)$ and participation probability $p_{i,t} = \sigma(V_{i,t})$. Innovation share is updated using the discrete replicator equation

$$p_{t+1} = p_t + \Delta t \, p_t(1 - p_t)(\Delta_0 - 2\lambda H), \tag{64}$$

with $(\Delta t, \Delta_0, \lambda) = (0.18, 0.22, 0.42)$.

5.2 Simulation Results

Table 1 Simulation summary statistics ($N = 100$, $T = 60$).

Metric	Value
Number of agents N	100
Number of rounds T	60
Mean tenure (years)	11.84
Hegemony index H	0.586
Mean voice probability (round 1)	0.719
Mean voice probability (round 60)	0.007
Innovation share (round 1)	0.620
Innovation share (round 60)	0.081
Mean front-stage masking gap	0.250

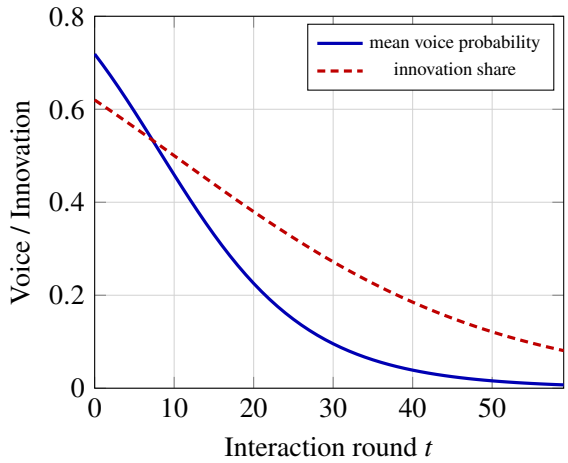

Figure 4: Simulation time series of mean voice probability and innovation share. Both curves decline across rounds; voice probability falls sharply first, followed by innovation share, consistent with participation loss preceding semantic contraction.

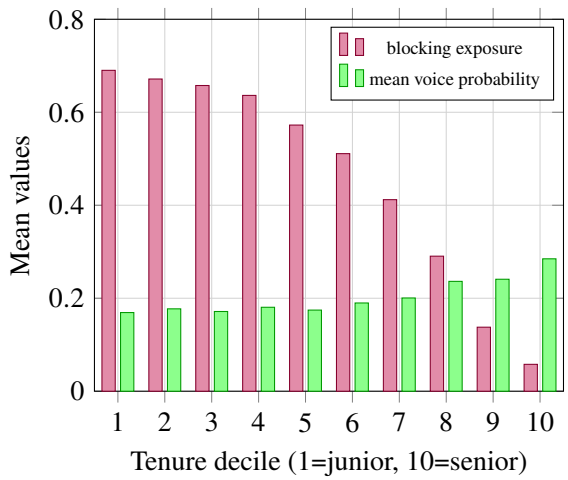

Figure 5: Stratified outcomes by tenure decile. Junior deciles exhibit higher blocking exposure and lower mean voice probability, while senior deciles show the opposite profile, consistent with the direction implied by $\Psi(\Delta\tau)$.

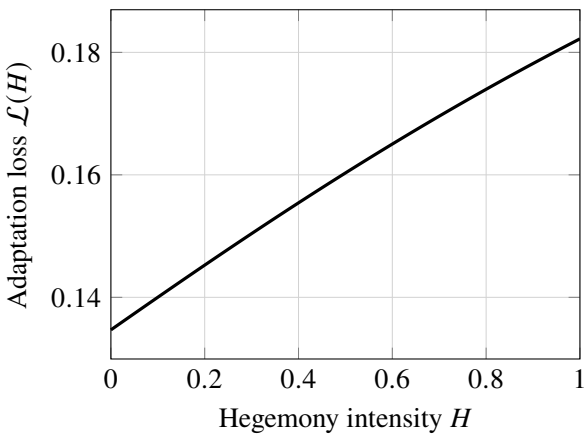

Figure 6: Adaptation loss as a function of hegemony intensity. The loss curve is monotone increasing over $H \in [0, 1]$, indicating that stronger tenure-weighted dominance degrades aggregate sensing quality.

6. Conclusion

This paper argues that the phrase "you have only been here for a few years" is not a harmless joke but a compact governance device: it converts elapsed time into a claim about who may define reality. The CH model makes this conversion process explicit by linking tenure (τ), discursive weight (Ω), blocking intensity (Ψ), and field-level pressure (H) in a single causal architecture.

The main finding is straightforward. When organizations treat seniority as a sufficient source of epistemic legitimacy, they do not merely rank people; they rewire information flow. At the micro level, newer members face reduced expressive capacity and faster silencing. At the macro level, communication channels narrow, innovative discourse is crowded out, and adaptive sensing becomes brittle under regime change [27, 8, 17].

The practical implication is to redesign decision rules rather than rely on moral appeals. Institutions can preserve the value of experience while avoiding tenure absolutism by increasing evidence-weighted evaluation, reducing cross-rank blocking opportunities, and treating silence trajectories as risk indicators instead of personal traits [14, 15, 11]. In other words, anti-bullying governance works best when it targets mechanisms, not slogans.

This paper is intentionally stylized, and its equations should be read as an analyzable baseline rather than a complete empirical map. Future work should calibrate parameters across sectors, test threshold effects in panel data, and examine how digital communication tools reshape temporal gatekeeping. Even so, the central warning remains: a system can maximize internal deference while minimizing truth-tracking capacity, and that inversion is precisely where organizational fragility begins.

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